

You Are a Benefactor of the Will

Romans 7 Unlocked Covenant Versus Sonship

Somewhere near the beginning or middle of last year, as we were teaching on the Born-Again Trail, we started making some strong statements. One was this: Romans 7 is not talking about a born-again man merely having trouble with his flesh. It is talking about an unregenerated Jew who received the law and could not keep it.

Romans 7 describes the dilemma he was in because he had a sin nature that could not keep the law. Until I understood that with finality in my spirit, the rest of Romans 7 and the whole book of Romans stayed locked up.

As the Born-Again Trail opened up, I began to find out that because of my rebirth and who He made me in Christ, I had an inheritance. I had preached covenant as much as I knew, and then I would turn around and preach that I was a son. The farther I journeyed down the Born-Again Trail, the clearer the distinction became: covenant versus sonship.

Finally I had enough confidence to say it plainly: I had a covenant that resulted in my sonship.

That changes how you think, how you give, and how you approach God. I have an inheritance. I am a son of God. I stopped standing outside God's house screaming that I have a covenant, and I went inside, sat down at the dinner table, and started eating.

Adoption Papers Are Not the Way Sons Ask Their Father

God used several examples to help me, especially because Daniel and Tawny are adopted. Tawny was adopted from the Philippines. When people asked her, "Are you adopted?" she would say, "I used to be," because she knows the adoption is complete. She is a full-fledged Roberson.

Daniel was adopted sight unseen while his biological mother was carrying him. But she is no longer his mother. He is bone of my bone and marrow of my marrow. He is my son.

When the adoption process began in you, the literal completion will come when you receive a glorified body. But you do not have another spiritual father claiming rights over you. You have been born again. God is your Father. The devil does not have his nature in you anymore, so tell him to get out.

God asked me how David, Bill, and Steve come to me when they want something.

I said, "Trust me, God, they come totally on sonship."

If we are not home, they raid the refrigerator. They do not outgrow it. Grown men still raid the refrigerator based on sonship.

Then God asked, "What would you do if every time Daniel and Tawny came to ask for something, they got their adoption papers out to prove to you that you needed to feed them, heal them, or give them medicine?"

I told Him they would get the worst correction they had ever had. If one of the other children said, "You are just adopted anyway," that would be one degree short of the death penalty in our house. Adoption is complete.

The Covenant Is With Sinners; Sons Have Already Inherited

In my spirit, I have already inherited the nature of God and been seated in heavenly places with Christ Jesus. The sinners outside are the ones God has a covenant with: a covenant to make them sons.

God has a covenant with sinners to write His laws in their hearts and minds, and to remember their sins and iniquities no more. When they inherit that will, they become sons like I am. Until then, they are still children of the devil and must be born again.

I have been born again, and my rights are settling deeply into my spirit. Those rights take control of everything. When they begin to take over the soul, the soul discovers it does not have more power than the regenerated spirit. It used to run you around, but it does not have that power anymore.

When you find out you are a son of God, things you used to think were important do not seem so important. You begin to look beyond this life and ask, "How is my life going to be with Him?"

The Father Wants His Sons to Tell the World About the Will

We are beginning to understand our rights, and faith is increasing. It is dividing provision from pound. We are finding out by inheritance how much He wants to do for us.

The bottom line is that your Father wants you to go tell the whole sinning world that He has a covenant with them for sonship. If they will let Him, He will read the will to them. The Testator died and rose to administer that will.

He wants sinners to know that if they accept this will, they will become beneficiaries and become sons and daughters of God.

Hebrews Shows the New Testament as the Final Will

Hebrews 9 differentiates between the two covenants: the Old Testament and the New Testament, the covenant that resulted in sonship.

Hebrews 9:13-14 says:

"For if the blood of bulls and of goats,
and the ashes of an heifer sprinkling the unclean,
sanctifieth to the purifying of the flesh:
how much more shall the blood of Christ,
who through the eternal Spirit
offered himself without spot to God,
purge your conscience from dead works
to serve the living God?"

The blood of bulls and goats could sanctify only to the purifying of the flesh. It could not touch the spirit. The blood of Christ purges the conscience from dead works so we can serve the living God.

Verse 15 says:

"And for this cause
he is the mediator of the new testament,
that by means of death,
for the redemption of the transgressions
that were under the first testament,
they which are called
might receive the promise of eternal inheritance."

A testament is a final will. A living man may have a will, but his testament is the final will that goes into force by death. Jesus is the Testator. He died for the redemption of the transgressions under the first covenant so those called could receive eternal inheritance: sonship.

The Death of the Testator Puts the Will Into Force

Hebrews says:

"For where a testament is,
there must also of necessity be the death of the testator.
For a testament is of force after men are dead:
otherwise it is of no strength at all
while the testator liveth."

If you saw me walking around with a million dollars and five houses, and I did not have them yesterday, you might ask where they came from. I could say, "An uncle died. I went to the reading of the will and testament, and he left me a million dollars and five houses."

The death of the testator set the will in motion, and I inherited the contents. I became a beneficiary of that will.

That is what happened in Christ. The Testator died, the final will went into force, and I inherited sonship.

Animal Sacrifices Could Not Make Worshipers Perfect

Hebrews 10:1 says:

"For the law having a shadow
of good things to come,
and not the very image of the things,
can never with those sacrifices
which they offered year by year continually
make the comers thereunto perfect."

Those sacrifices were purged by animal blood, but they could never make the worshipers perfect because they could not purge the conscience from sin or give a new nature.

If they could have done that, they would have ceased to be offered. Instead, there was a remembrance of sins every year.

"For it is not possible
that the blood of bulls and of goats
should take away sins."

God took no pleasure in the slaughter of bulls, goats, sheep, and calves. There is nothing in His nature that delights in that. Think of Solomon's temple dedication with thousands upon thousands of sacrifices and torrents of blood. Under the shadow, it came as close as it could to the real, but it was still not God's pleasure.

If the glory was so strong under Solomon's shadow that the priests could not stand to minister, what is waiting for us under the true when God has a covenant with every sinner on earth and the will can be read to them?

Jesus Came to Do the Will That Sanctifies Us Forever

Hebrews 10:5-7 says:

"Sacrifice and offering thou wouldst not,
but a body hast thou prepared me:
in burnt offerings and sacrifices for sin
thou hast had no pleasure.
Then said I,
Lo, I come
(in the volume of the book it is written of me,)
to do thy will, O God."

Circle the word "will." Jesus came to fulfill the final will and testament. In doing so, He took away the first so He could establish the second.

Hebrews 10:10 says:

"By the which will
we are sanctified
through the offering of the body of Jesus Christ
once for all."

By that will, we are sanctified through the offering of Jesus' body once for all. I have inherited the will. I am a son of God.

One Offering Perfected the Sanctified Forever

Every priest under the old order stood daily, offering the same sacrifices that could never take away sins. But Jesus, after offering one sacrifice for sins forever, sat down at the right hand of God.

He is now expecting until His enemies are made His footstool, and mine also.

Hebrews 10 says:

"For by one offering
he hath perfected for ever
them that are sanctified."

Then the Holy Spirit is a witness:

"This is the covenant that I will make with them
after those days, saith the Lord,
I will put my laws into their hearts,
and in their minds will I write them;
and their sins and iniquities
will I remember no more."

Where remission is, there is no more offering for sin.

The New Covenant Offered to Sinners Makes Sons When Received

The covenant God offers the sinner is this: "Let Me read this will to you. If you let Me fulfill this covenant, I will write My laws in your heart and mind, give you a new nature, and remember your sins and iniquities no more."

I am a son because I had the will read to me, accepted it, and became a beneficiary.

The rebirth is described here. He wrote His laws into our hearts and minds. He remembered our sins and iniquities no more because we had a change of nature. Romans says the old man of sin was destroyed and replaced with a new nature.

The Law Revealed the Nature the New Birth Replaced

The laws God writes into the heart are the nature behind the Ten Commandments. The Ten Commandments describe that part of God's nature given to spiritually dead men, even though they could not keep it.

Paul said:

"I had not known sin, but by the law:
for I had not known lust,
except the law had said,
Thou shalt not covet."

A spiritually dead man, born in that condition, does not know anything else until someone tells him he is not supposed to sin. Then he tries to stop and discovers the dilemma:

"The good that I would, I do not:
but the evil which I would not, that I do."

With his mind, he wanted to keep the law. But the sin nature within him would not let him.

Thank God, Romans 6 says sin lost dominion over me. The world and the devil cannot force me to do anything I do not will to do. The law of the Spirit of life, my regenerated human spirit with God's life in it, replaced the old law of sin and death that came from the old spirit.

The New Nature Cleans the Soul and Prepares the Inheritance

Sin lost dominion over me. When I let the Holy Spirit bring me forward, especially through praying in tongues, the new nature begins to clean house. It clears cobwebs out of the soul, removes what should not be there, prepares me for great inheritance, and lets me read His will to the whole world.

Romans 8 says:

"There is therefore now no condemnation
to them which are in Christ Jesus,
who walk not after the flesh,
but after the Spirit."

No condemning sentence under the reign of the unregenerated spirit can be carried out in those who walk after the regenerated spirit. I walk after the nature that canceled sin.

If you do not know you are free, how will you ever walk there?

Romans 2 Shows the New Nature Judging the Thoughts

Romans 2:10-13 says:

"Glory, honour, and peace,
to every man that worketh good,
to the Jew first,
and also to the Gentile:
for there is no respect of persons with God.
For as many as have sinned without law
shall also perish without law:
and as many as have sinned in the law
shall be judged by the law;
for not the hearers of the law are just before God,
but the doers of the law shall be justified."

At first that sounds like a contradiction, because Romans 3:20 says:

"Therefore by the deeds of the law
there shall no flesh be justified in his sight:
for by the law is the knowledge of sin."

How can Paul say the doers of the law will be justified, and then say no flesh will be justified by the deeds of the law? The answer comes in Romans 2:14-15:

"For when the Gentiles,
which have not the law,
do by nature the things contained in the law,
these, having not the law,
are a law unto themselves:
which shew the work of the law
written in their hearts,
their conscience also bearing witness,
and their thoughts the mean while
accusing or else excusing one another."

He is talking about the new nature. Gentiles who did not receive the law by commandment can, by the new nature, do the things contained in the law. The work of the law is written in their hearts. Their conscience bears witness.

The thoughts accusing or excusing one another are the operations of the new conscience. The new nature is alive enough to condemn what is not of God and refuse to excuse it.

I have Jesus Christ. Sin has lost dominion. I walk no longer after the unregenerated spirit but after the new nature. That nature condemns everything not of God.

Do not tell me I do not know right from wrong. I am alive at last.